

ILLINOIS DEPARTMENT OF CHILDREN AND FAMILY SERVICES

Placement Services Division

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PLACEMENT SUMMARY AND TRANSFER RECORD

Child: Marcus D. Whitfield DOB: 03/03/2016

DCFS Case #: 2023-CK-04892 Effective Date: 02/04/2026

Current Placement: Ms. Renee Carter (licensed foster parent)

Address: 1847 S. Hamlin Ave., Chicago, IL 60623

Caseworker: Patricia Delgado, LCSW Date of Summary: 02/06/2026

PLACEMENT HISTORY

Marcus D. Whitfield has been in DCFS custody since 04/2023 following removal from the home of his biological mother, Maria Ruiz, due to substantiated neglect (medical neglect, environmental hazard, inadequate supervision). Parental rights are currently under review.

- Placement 1 (04/2023 - 11/2023): Ms. Linda Thompson, 4218 W. Cermak Rd., Chicago. Disrupted due to caregiver inability to manage behavioral and medical needs.
- Placement 2 (11/2023 - 06/2024): Mr. and Mrs. George Alvarez, 2915 S. Pulaski Rd., Chicago. Disrupted due to caregiver relocation out of state.
- Placement 3 (06/2024 - 02/2026): Ms. Janet Wilkins, 3847 W. 26th Street, Chicago. Disrupted due to caregiver health issues and inability to maintain medical appointment schedule.
- Placement 4 (02/04/2026 - present): Ms. Renee Carter, 1847 S. Hamlin Ave., Chicago. Current placement. Licensed foster parent with experience caring for children with special needs.

BIOLOGICAL FAMILY INFORMATION

Mother: Maria Ruiz (born ~1989, Guatemalan national, US resident since 2015). Currently uncontactable. Last known address: 4507 W. 31st Street, Chicago, IL 60623. History of substance use. History of domestic violence (victim). Prior DCFS intake interview (approximately 2017, conducted with interpreter) included the following notation attributed to the biological mother regarding a health concern: "*condición pulmonar — tratamiento 6 meses.*"

Father: Unknown. Not identified on birth certificate.

MEDICAL SUMMARY

Marcus has multiple chronic medical conditions requiring ongoing specialist care. Diagnoses include ASD Level 2, ADHD, PTSD, FASD, severe persistent asthma (4 hospitalizations with intubation), suspected Crohn's disease, pica with elevated blood lead, and Neurofibromatosis Type 1. He sees multiple specialists who do not appear to communicate with each other. Medical records are fragmented across prior placements and county systems. His prior PCP (Dr. Anita Sharma) is unreachable.

EDUCATIONAL STATUS

Marcus was enrolled at Roosevelt Elementary School through 02/03/2026. He transferred to Lincoln Elementary School on 02/03/2026 following the placement change. An IEP is on file from Roosevelt Elementary (08/2025) but has not been formally transferred to Lincoln.

OUTSTANDING OBLIGATIONS

- Environmental lead inspection of current foster home has not been completed. Prior foster homes were not inspected.
- No dental examination documented across any of the four placements.
- IEP transfer to Lincoln Elementary required per IDEA within 30 days of enrollment.
- Medical records consolidation needed — records from at least two prior county systems remain incomplete.

Patricia Delgado, LCSW

